

FREE GUIDE

How to plan the perfect magic for your corporate event

A practical guide to arrive with clear ideas before talking to any supplier: which format to choose, when to schedule it, and what to ask before hiring.

1. Start by defining the event's goal

Before thinking about format, it helps to be clear on what you actually want the magic to achieve within the event. Breaking the ice at a networking session is not the same as closing a convention with a memorable moment. The goal shapes everything else.

Questions to clarify the goal

- ☐ Are you trying to spark conversation between attendees who don't know each other?
- ☐ Is it a closing moment meant to leave a lasting impression of the event?
- ☐ Do you want to reinforce your team's culture or values?
- ☐ Is it meant to draw visitors to a stand or specific spot?

2. Choose the format based on the moment in the event

Close-up magic

Moves between attendees in small groups. Ideal for cocktail hours, networking, receptions and moments where people are standing and socialising.

Stage show

A performance for the whole group at once. Works best as a closing moment, the central highlight of a convention, or after dinner.

Combined format

Starting with close-up magic during the reception and closing with a stage show is the most common combination for full-day events.

3. Build in a time margin

Close-up magic usually works well in blocks of 45-90 minutes. A stage show typically runs 20 to 45 minutes. It's important to leave margin in the event

schedule, without squeezing the time right before or after.

4. What to ask before hiring

Checklist before requesting a quote

- ☐ Do they have real experience with corporate events, not just private ones?
- ☐ Can they show video of real performances, not just promotional material?
- ☐ Does the service include sound equipment and materials, or do you need to provide them?
- ☐ Can they invoice a company and work with your event agency if there is one?
- ☐ How do they adapt if the group is very international or mixed in languages?

5. Get ahead of the calendar

High-demand dates (year-end closings, Christmas, seasonal conventions) get booked weeks or months in advance. Starting to talk to suppliers as soon as you have an approximate date helps avoid missing out on the best options.

Want help applying this to your specific event?

Talk to us

↓ Download this guide as a PDF